



Land Use

Conservation – Building – Planning

FY27 Budget Presentation

Brian Gingras – Building Commissioner

Stephen Wallace – Director of Planning and Economic Development

Herlin Jaime – Conservation Agent

March 5, 2027



Department Overview



Key Services

Conservation Department

- Review and enforce compliance with the **Massachusetts Wetlands Protection Act** and local wetlands bylaws
- Issue permits for work near wetlands, waterways, and floodplains
- Conduct site inspections and monitor ongoing projects for compliance
- Provide guidance on **wetlands management, erosion control, and habitat protection**
- Advise the public on environmental regulations and best practices

Building Department

- Issue permits for building, demolition, signs, and the specialty codes.
- Enforce the **Massachusetts State Building Code** and local building regulations
- Conduct inspections for **structural, electrical, plumbing, and fire safety compliance**
- Review construction plans for adherence to zoning and safety codes
- Maintain records of permits, inspections, and code violations
- Provide guidance to homeowners, contractors, and developers on **permit requirements**

Department Overview

Key Services



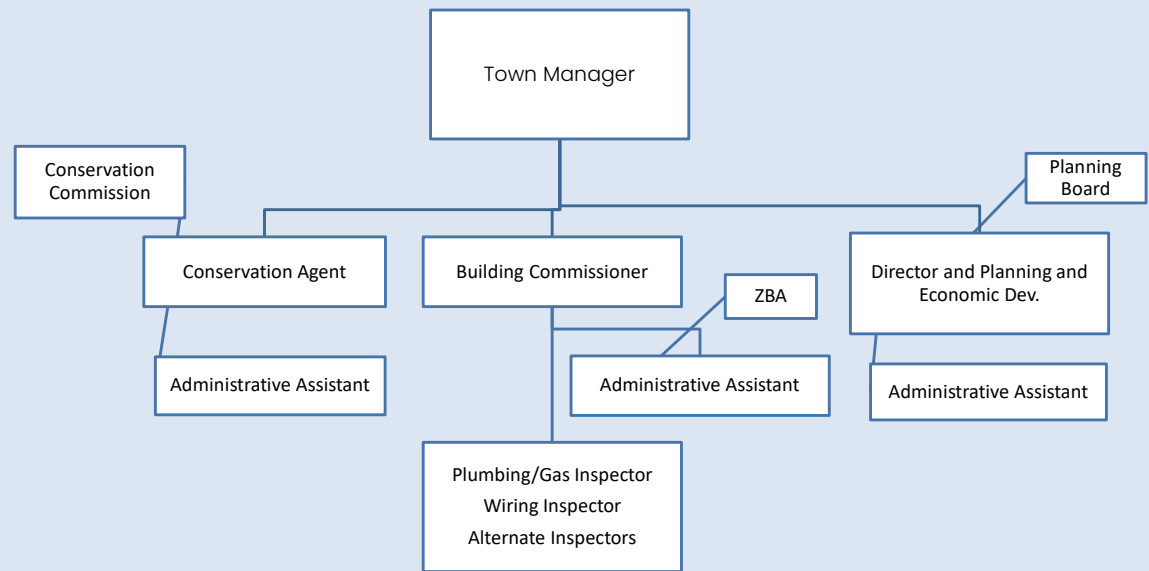
Planning & Economic Development Department

- Prepare, update, and implement the master plan, zoning bylaws, and subdivision regulations
- Review and process applications for special permits, site plans approvals, stormwater permits, and subdivision of land
- Coordinate long-term economic development initiatives and business attraction/retention programs
- Conduct housing, land use, and demographic studies
- Manage grant programs for planning, infrastructure, and community development
- Staffs the Planning Board and Economic Development Committee
- Facilitate public engagement and community workshops

Organizational Structure

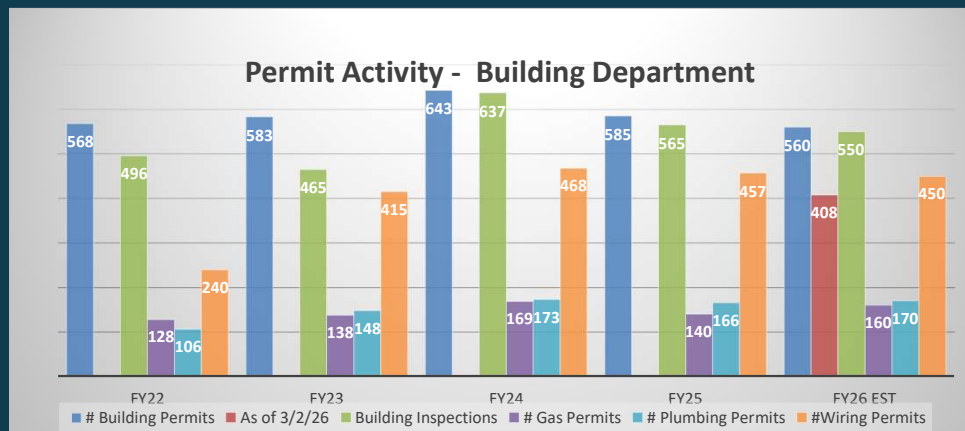
Staffing Overview

Land use is composed of 3 departments. All department heads report directly to the Town Manager. The Conservation Agent staffs the Conservation Commission as well as supervising one part-time administrative assistant. The Director of Planning and economic development supervises one full-time administrative assistant and staffs the Planning Board. The Building Commissioner supervises one administrative assistant and four specialized code inspectors. The Building administrative assistant staffs and assists the Zoning Board of Appeals with administrative tasks including receiving applications and drafting decisions.



Service Trends by Fiscal Year

- Conservation receives approximately 100 filings per year including requests for administrators' determination, NOIs, RDAs and requests for certificates of compliance. Many conservation applications, permits, and approvals directly relate to the volume of Building Permits issued.
- The Planning Department receives and processes between 20 and 40 applications per year on behalf of the Planning Board. While the department receives applications for the Planning Board, this is only a small portion of the work of the department. Typically, the result of the Planning Department's work can be directly shown by the volume and nature of the Building Permits issued later on.
- The Building Department has maintained a steady volume in the last 5 years, the nature of the permits issued changes from year to year. The current trend has been focused on improving existing properties, although there is some sign of new residential development coming as well as some level of commercial development interest. For the sake of this fiscal year, the figure shown represent a "best guess" based on permits issued to date, the red bar shows the actual as of 3/2/2026.



\$447,963.33

Total FY27 Budget Request

The proposed budget of \$447,963.33 amount reflects a 1.77% increase from the prior year, ensuring continued delivery of essential services and addressing rising operational costs.

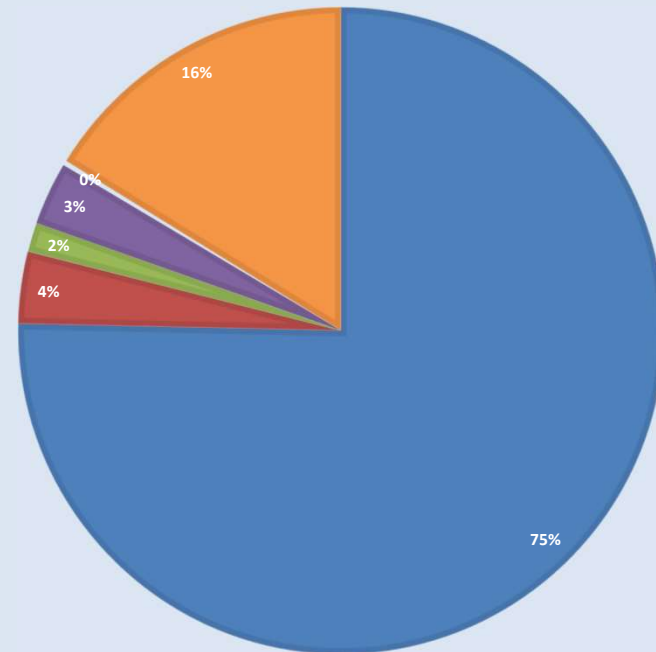
ORG	OBJ	DESCRIPTION	FY24 FY24 ACTUAL		FY25 FY25 ACTUAL		FY2026	FY2027	\$ CHANGE	% CHANGE
			BUDGET		BUDGET					
11701	511000	PLANNING BOARD DIRECTOR	108,177.68	39,736.80	108,177.68	70,272.00	106,374.80	112,723.00	6,348.20	5.97%
11701	511001	SALARIES CLERICAL	112,217.39	101,330.31	118,436.46	47,471.76	130,563.67	117,869.07	-12,694.60	-9.72%
11701	511003	SALARIES STAFF	5,000.00	222.75	5,000.00	893.62	5,000.00	5,000.00	0.00	0.00%
11701	511105	BUILDING COMMISSIONER	97,359.91	89,665.17	87,148.04	113,818.52	100,681.88	106,636.83	5,954.95	5.91%
11701	511106	CONSERVATION ADMINISTRATOR	48,095.56	45,101.33	68,262.00	63,175.58	72,137.06	80,684.43	8,547.37	11.85%
11701	514002	LONGEVITY PAY	4,700.00	2,350.00	2,350.00	2,350.00	2,350.00	0.00	-2,350.00	-100.00%
11701	519008	MILEAGE STIPEND	7,500.00	7,499.96	7,500.00	7,500.00	7,500.00	7,500.00	0.00	0.00%
		TOTAL SALARY - LAND USE	383,050.54	285,906.32	396,874.18	305,481.48	424,607.41	430,413.33	5,805.92	1.37%
11702	531007	RECORDINGS-REGISTRY OF DEEDS	150	0	150	0	150.00	150.00	0.00	0.00%
11702	531013	CONSULTANT					0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00%
11702	531017	PUBLICATIONS	2,100.00	1,002.41	2,100.00	786.45	2,100.00	2,100.00	0.00	0.00%
11702	534200	PRINTING-PLANNING	300	110	300	80	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00%
11702	534400	PURCHASE OF SERVICE	650	61	650	0	0.00	2,000.00	2,000.00	200000.00%
11702	534500	ADVERTISING	2,250.00	3,681.27	3,750.00	1,290.00	2,250.00	2,250.00	0.00	0.00%
11702	540000	OFFICE SUPPLIES - CONSERVATION					0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00%
11702	558000	OFFICE SUPPLIES	2,560.00	1,581.15	2,660.00	369.37	2,600.00	2,600.00	0.00	0.00%
11702	571000	UNIFORM ALLOWANCE	360	336	360	350	900.00	900.00	0.00	
		REIMBURSEMENT								0.00%
11702	573000	MILEAGE REIMBURSEMENT	285	241.51	850	692.52	1,350.00	1,350.00	0.00	0.00%
11702	573100	DUES/MEMBERSHIP	1,066.00	325	1,066.00	371	1,150.00	1,150.00	0.00	0.00%
11702	573100	MEETINGS/SCHOOL	3,409.00	1,235.14	3,409.00	2,134.00	5,050.00	5,050.00	0.00	0.00%
		TOTAL EXPENSES - LAND USE	13,130.00	8,573.48	15,295.00	6,073.34	15,550.00	17,550.00	2,000.00	12.86%
		TOTAL - LAND USE	396,180.54	294,479.80	412,169.18	311,554.82	440,157.41	447,963.33	7,805.92	1.77%

Funding Sources

The Land Use Department operations are funded from the General Fund and offset by the fees charged for permits and applications.

FUNDING SOURCES BASED ON CURRENT PERMIT TRENDS.

■ Building Permits ■ Specialty Permits ■ Sheet Metal ■ Planning Fees ■ ZBA fees ■ General Fund





THANK YOU!
ANY QUESTIONS?

Brian Gingras, Building Commissioner

Stephen Wallace, Director of Planning and Economic Development

Herling Jaime, Conservation Agent

March 5, 2026